Management Fundamentals - Solved Question Papers

MBA Semester I (2024 Pattern) | Paper 1: [6430]-507 | Paper 2: [6380]-5007

PAPER 1 : [6430]-507 | MF 507 MJ-GC 07 Management Fundamentals

Q1) Answer any five out of eight (2 marks each) - all eight solved

a) What are the characteristics of SMART goals?

SMART goals are goals that are clearly defined and trackable. The characteristics are:

- **S - Specific:** clear and well defined (what, who, why).
- **M - Measurable:** can be measured in numbers (e.g. increase sales by 10%).
- **A - Achievable:** realistic and attainable with available resources.
- **R - Relevant:** linked to the organisation's mission and objectives.
- **T - Time-bound:** has a deadline (e.g. within 6 months).

b) What is Workplace?

A workplace is the **physical or virtual location where employees perform their work** (office, factory, retail store, home office, co-working space). It includes the physical environment, tools, culture and relationships which affect productivity and well-being.

c) Define Decision Making.

Decision making is the process of **choosing the best course of action from the available alternatives** to achieve an objective or to solve a problem. It is the essence of management, as every function (planning, organising, controlling) involves decisions.

d) What are Mintzberg's informational roles?

- **Monitor:** scans environment for information (reading reports, market news).
- **Disseminator:** passes important information to subordinates.
- **Spokesperson:** gives information to outsiders (media, government) on behalf of the organisation.

e) List out the steps in decision making process.

1. Identify the problem
2. Identify decision criteria
3. Allocate weights to criteria
4. Develop alternatives
5. Analyse alternatives
6. Select the best alternative
7. Implement the decision
8. Evaluate decision effectiveness (follow-up)

f) Define leadership.

Leadership is the **ability to influence and inspire individuals or groups to willingly work towards achievement of organisational goals**. A leader gives vision, direction and motivation.

g) What is Centralization and Decentralization?

Centralisation: decision-making authority is concentrated at the top level of management (e.g. a small family business). **Decentralisation:** decision-making authority is delegated and spread to the middle and lower levels (e.g. branch managers of a bank have authority to sanction small loans). Decentralisation gives faster decisions and motivates employees, while centralisation gives better control and uniformity.

h) List out the various decision-making styles.

- **Directive style:** low tolerance for ambiguity, rational and quick; decisions are made fast with minimum information.
- **Analytic style:** high tolerance for ambiguity; wants more information and considers many alternatives before deciding.
- **Conceptual style:** broad outlook, considers many alternatives, creative and long-term oriented.
- **Behavioural style:** people oriented, accepts suggestions of others, avoids conflict and likes to be accepted.

Q2) Answer any two out of three (5 marks each) - all three solved

a) Discuss the importance of customer to a manager's job.

The customer is the reason for the existence of any business (Peter Drucker: 'The purpose of business is to create a customer'). Importance to a manager's job:

- **Source of revenue and survival:** customers' purchase gives sales and profit; a manager must retain existing customers and win new ones.
- **Direction for planning and decisions:** customer needs decide product design, pricing, quality and service planning.
- **Customer satisfaction and loyalty** reduce marketing cost; satisfied customers bring repeat sales and word-of-mouth.
- **Feedback for improvement and innovation:** complaints and suggestions help the manager improve processes.
- **Competitive advantage:** better customer service differentiates the firm (e.g. Amazon, Zomato).
- **Control and performance measure:** the manager's performance is measured by customer satisfaction, complaint rate and retention.
- **Employee orientation:** a manager has to train and motivate staff to serve customers (internal customers as well).

b) Elaborate the features of a good plan.

- **Clear objectives:** specific, measurable goals.
- **Simplicity and clarity:** easily understood by all who carry it out.
- **Flexibility:** adaptable to changing situations (contingency plans).
- **Realistic and feasible:** based on available resources and facts.
- **Based on forecasts and sound information.**
- **Consistency and co-ordination:** fit with other plans and organisational goals.
- **Participation:** involve those who implement; **economy:** benefits more than cost.
- **Provision for control:** standards and review/feedback, with proper time frame.

c) Discuss various approaches to setting goals.

- **Traditional (top-down) approach:** top management sets goals, which are broken into sub-goals for lower levels; lower levels have little participation, which gives clarity but may reduce commitment.
- **Participative / bottom-up approach:** employees participate in setting goals, so commitment and ownership are higher (as in MBO).
- **Management by Objectives (MBO):** manager and subordinate jointly set measurable goals, review progress and evaluate at the end of period.
- **SMART goals approach:** goals are specific, measurable, achievable, relevant and time-bound.
- **Stretch goals:** challenging goals which go beyond normal capacity to inspire high performance (e.g. Tata's targets).
- **Balanced scorecard approach:** goals are set from four perspectives - financial, customer, internal process, learning and growth.
- **Goal hierarchy / cascading and OKR (Objectives and Key Results):** organisation-wide goals are cascaded to departments and individuals.

Q3) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Discuss the various techniques of control in the context of a manufacturing organisation.

Control is the process of measuring actual performance, comparing it with standards and taking corrective action. In manufacturing, control techniques are:

Technique	Description in manufacturing context
Budgetary control	Budgets for production, material, labour and overheads; compare actual with budget to control cost, e.g. flexible budget for varying output
Standard costing and variance analysis	Standard cost per unit is set and material, labour, overhead variances are analysed
Break-even analysis	Finds the minimum production/sales volume to avoid loss; used in product mix and pricing decisions
Statistical quality control (SQC) / Six Sigma / TQM	Control charts, sampling inspection, defect reduction; ISO 9001 standards
Inventory control: EOQ, ABC analysis, JIT, MRP	Reduces holding cost; Just-in-Time (Toyota) supplies material when needed; ABC controls costly items more strictly
PERT/CPM and Gantt charts	Control of time and schedule of projects like plant installation, new product launch
Production planning and control (PPC)	Scheduling, routing, dispatching and follow-up to ensure timely output
Maintenance control	Preventive and predictive maintenance (TPM) of machines to reduce breakdowns
Ratio analysis and financial control	Profitability, liquidity, productivity and capacity-utilisation ratios
Management audit / MIS / Balanced Scorecard / Kaizen	Overall review of performance; information systems for timely feedback; continuous improvement

Conclusion: A manufacturing firm should use a combination of these techniques to control cost, quality, time and quantity.

b) Analyse various managerial competencies expected from a manager working in a manufacturing industry.

Competencies are the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to perform managerial work effectively. For a manager in a manufacturing industry, they are:

Competency	What it means in a manufacturing industry
Technical competence	Knowledge of production processes, machines, quality systems, lean/Six Sigma, safety norms
Planning and organising	Production scheduling, capacity planning, resource allocation, inventory planning
Decision making and problem solving	Quick decisions on breakdowns, rejections, delays, make or buy; use of data and root-cause analysis
Leadership and motivation	Leading shop-floor workers and supervisors, handling unions and shift teams
Communication and interpersonal skill	Clear instructions, coordination between purchase, production, marketing, quality
Cost and financial awareness	Cost control, budgeting, productivity improvement, waste reduction
Quality and safety orientation	Compliance with ISO, environment norms, worker safety; zero-defect mind-set
Adaptability and innovation / technology skill	Use of automation, ERP, IoT, Industry 4.0; accepting change and continuous improvement (Kaizen)
Ethical and social responsibility; sustainability	Environmental compliance, ethical sourcing and CSR
Conceptual and analytical thinking	Seeing the whole supply chain and long-term strategy

Katz's three skills (technical, human, conceptual) all matter: at the supervisory level, technical skill dominates; at higher levels, conceptual skill becomes more important.

Q4) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Discuss the concept of boundaryless organisation and virtual organisation structure with examples.

Boundaryless organisation (term popularised by Jack Welch of General Electric) is a structure that is not defined or limited by the horizontal, vertical or external boundaries imposed by a predefined structure. The organisation tries to remove the barriers between levels, departments, and between the firm and its customers, suppliers and competitors.

- **Removing vertical boundaries:** flat structure, empowered teams, fewer levels.
- **Removing horizontal boundaries:** cross-functional teams, free flow of work across departments.
- **Removing external boundaries:** alliances with suppliers, customers, even competitors; global operations.
- **Example:** GE under Jack Welch; Google and Apple with open collaboration; Tata's open innovation.

Virtual organisation is a small, core organisation that outsources major business functions to outside specialists and is connected through information technology (a network organisation). Work is done by people at different locations through the internet, with little physical office.

- **Features:** use of IT, flexibility, outsourcing, temporary alliances, low overhead, geographical independence.
- **Examples:** Nike (designs shoes, manufacturing outsourced), Dell (assembly), Zomato/Uber (platform with outside partners) and freelance-based consulting firms, open source teams (Linux).
- **Advantages:** low cost, global talent, flexibility. **Limitations:** weak control, security and trust issues, low loyalty and cultural differences.

b) What are the potential challenges of planning in a dynamic environment and how can an organisation overcome them?

Challenges

- **Uncertainty and rapid change** in technology, customer taste, competition, regulation make forecasts unreliable.
- **Plans become outdated quickly;** long-term plans lose value.
- **Inaccurate forecasting and incomplete information.**
- **Rigidity:** formal plans may reduce flexibility and creativity and delay response.
- **High cost and time** of continuous planning and revision; employee resistance to repeated change.
- **Unforeseen events** (pandemic, supply disruption, war) and difficulty in coordinating across departments.

How to overcome

- **Flexible and rolling plans:** revise annual plans every quarter; keep the plan short-term and specific, but the direction long-term.
- **Contingency and scenario planning:** prepare alternative plans (best, expected, worst case).
- **Environmental scanning** and use of data analytics to detect early signals (SWOT, PESTEL).
- **Decentralised planning:** involve lower levels and those near the market, so plans are practical and faster.
- **Build organisational agility:** cross-functional teams, empowered employees, agile methods.
- **Strong communication and training;** keep reserves/buffers (cash, inventory), and strategic alliances to share risk.

Q5) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Analyse the advantages and disadvantages of matrix structure. In what type of organisation is matrix structure commonly used?

Matrix structure combines functional departmentation with project/product departmentation. Employees report to two bosses - a functional manager and a project manager - which creates a dual chain of command.

Advantages	Disadvantages
Efficient use of specialised resources and people shared across projects	Dual command causes confusion and conflict in authority (violates unity of command)
Better coordination between functions and projects	Power struggles between functional and project managers
Flexible and adaptable to change; quick response	Role ambiguity, stress and work overload for employees
Better communication and information sharing; teamwork	Needs more meetings and lengthy negotiation, so slow decisions
Develops managerial and technical skills of staff; motivates	Higher administrative cost; requires good interpersonal skills and training

Advantages	Disadvantages
Customer and project focus; best utilisation of expertise	Accountability is unclear - no one clear owner of results

Where commonly used: in organisations with multiple complex projects needing specialised skills - aerospace and defence (Boeing, HAL), construction and engineering companies (L&T), IT consulting / software firms (Infosys, TCS), pharmaceutical and R&D organisations, advertising agencies, multinational companies with geographic and product dimensions (Procter & Gamble, Unilever), and hospitals/universities.

b) A non-profit organisation is considering a new fund-raising initiative. How should the manager evaluate this decision using the various decision criteria?

The manager should follow a rational decision process and evaluate the initiative (e.g. a charity marathon, online crowdfunding or a donor dinner) against several criteria:

Decision criterion	Questions the manager should ask
Mission alignment	Does the initiative support the organisation's mission and values? Will it affect its image?
Financial return (cost-benefit)	What is the expected fund collected vs. cost (event cost, staff time)? Net funds raised, break-even point, ROI
Feasibility / resources	Are staff, volunteers, money, technology and time available? Legal permission (80G / FCRA) available?
Risk	Chance of low donation, reputation risk, over-dependence on one donor; use of EMV / probability of success
Stakeholder acceptance	Will donors, volunteers, beneficiaries and board approve? Donor fatigue?
Impact and sustainability	How many beneficiaries are helped? Will it give repeat donors and long-term funds?
Ethical / legal and social considerations	Transparency, accountability, no pressure on donors, use of funds only for stated purpose
Timing and alternatives	Is this the best use of resources compared with grants, CSR tie-ups, or digital campaigns?

Process

1. Define the objective (e.g. raise Rs. 10 lakh in 6 months) and decision criteria with weights.
2. Develop 2-3 alternatives (online campaign, corporate CSR partnership, event).
3. Score each alternative on weighted criteria (weighted scoring model); also do cost-benefit and risk analysis; take opinions from the team (group decision).
4. Select the best alternative, implement it with a clear plan, and evaluate results afterwards (funds raised vs. target) for learning.

PAPER 2 : [6380]-5007 | 107-GC-07 Management Fundamentals

Q1) Answer any five out of eight (2 marks each) - all eight solved

a) What are the core functions of management?

- **Planning** - deciding in advance what to do, how and when.
- **Organising** - arranging resources, tasks and authority.
- **Staffing / Leading (directing)** - motivating, guiding and communicating.
- **Controlling** - comparing actual with plan and taking corrective action. (Coordination runs through all.)

b) Define Decision Making.

Decision making is the process of **choosing the best course of action from the available alternatives** to achieve an objective or to solve a problem. It is the essence of management, as every function (planning, organising, controlling) involves decisions.

c) What are Mintzberg's interpersonal roles?

- **Figurehead:** performs ceremonial and symbolic duties (inaugurating, signing documents).
- **Leader:** motivates, guides and staffs subordinates.
- **Liaison:** maintains a network of contacts outside the unit to get information and favours.

d) List out any five managerial competencies.

- Communication
- Leadership and team building
- Decision making and problem solving
- Planning and organising
- Technical and analytical skills (also: time management, adaptability, emotional intelligence)

e) What is planning and control?

Planning is the process of setting objectives and deciding in advance the course of action to achieve them. **Control** is the process of monitoring actual performance, comparing it with the plan/standards and correcting deviations. Planning sets the standards and control checks them, so they are closely related ('twin functions').

f) Define Organising and Organisation.

Organising is the management function of arranging and grouping activities, assigning duties, and establishing authority and relationships to achieve objectives. **Organisation** is a group of people working together in a structured way for common goals (e.g. Tata Motors); it is the structure or framework created by organising.

g) List out the various decision-making styles.

- **Directive style:** low tolerance for ambiguity, rational and quick; decisions are made fast with minimum information.
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h) What are the characteristics of SMART goals?

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Q2) Answer any two out of three (5 marks each) - all three solved

a) Explain the classical approach to management.

The classical approach (late 19th - early 20th century) focuses on the efficiency of work and the organisation by scientific methods. It has three branches:

- **Scientific management (F. W. Taylor):** find 'one best way' of doing a job through time and motion study, scientific selection and training of workers, differential piece rate, and co-operation between management and workers. Focus: shop-floor efficiency. Contribution of Gilbreth (motion study) and Gantt (Gantt chart).
- **Administrative management (Henri Fayol):** five functions of management (planning, organising, commanding, coordinating and controlling) and **14 principles** such as division of work, authority and responsibility, discipline, unity of command, unity of direction, scalar chain, remuneration, esprit de corps.
- **Bureaucratic management (Max Weber):** ideal organisation with clear hierarchy, rules and procedures, division of labour, impersonal relationships, merit-based selection and career, written records.

Evaluation: It gave a foundation for management principles, increased productivity and standardisation.
Criticism: considers the worker as an economic machine, ignores human and social needs, rigid and mechanical, closed-system view.

b) Elaborate the features of good plan.

- **Clear objectives:** specific, measurable goals.
- **Simplicity and clarity:** easily understood by all who carry it out.
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- **Realistic and feasible:** based on available resources and facts.
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- **Participation:** involve those who implement; **economy:** benefits more than cost.
- **Provision for control:** standards and review/feedback, with proper time frame.

c) Explain the different types of decisions.

- **Programmed (routine) decisions:** repetitive and handled by rules and procedures, e.g. reordering stock, leave approvals.
- **Non-programmed (non-routine) decisions:** unique, unstructured, need judgement and creativity, e.g. entering a new market or acquisition.
- **Strategic decisions:** long-term, major, taken by top management (diversification); **tactical decisions:** middle level, to implement strategy; **operational decisions:** day-to-day, lower level.
- **Individual and group decisions:** by one person vs. by a committee/team.
- **Decisions under certainty, risk and uncertainty:** depending on the knowledge of outcomes and probabilities.
- **Organisational and personal decisions;** basic (important and costly to reverse) and routine decisions.

Q3) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) 'Controlling is the fundamental function that ensures work accomplishment according to plan.' Analyze this statement and outline the steps involved in controlling.

Analysis: Planning decides what is to be done, but without control there is no guarantee that it is done as planned. Controlling is the function which **checks whether the activities are going according to plan and corrects deviations**, so it is called the 'fundamental' function that ensures accomplishment. Reasons:

- It **links with planning**: standards are taken from plans; both are inseparable (planning is the base, control is the check).
- It **detects deviations early** and avoids waste, delay and loss.
- It **ensures that all functions and resources** (men, money, machines, material) are used according to the plan and in a co-ordinated way.
- It **guides and motivates employees** by performance standards and feedback; improves discipline and efficiency.
- It **helps in adapting plans** to changing situations, e.g. revising budgets, and gives information for future planning.

Steps in the controlling process

1. **Establishing standards:** set measurable performance standards (quantity, quality, cost, time) derived from objectives.
2. **Measuring actual performance:** collect data by observation, reports, statistical data, audits.
3. **Comparing actual performance with standards:** identify the deviation (variance).
4. **Analysing deviations:** find the causes and decide whether they are critical (management by exception).
5. **Taking corrective action:** correct the performance, retrain, change procedure, or revise the standard if it was unrealistic; then follow up.

Conclusion: the statement is true: without control, planning is only a wish. Planning and control together ensure the accomplishment of objectives.

b) Apply the concept of MBO to a real-world scenario. How would you set goals and measure performance for a sales team in a rapidly changing market?

MBO (Management by Objectives) was proposed by Peter Drucker (1954). The manager and subordinate jointly set specific, measurable objectives for a period, and performance is reviewed against those objectives. Example: Sales team of a consumer electronics company (Rs. 100 crore annual target) in a fast-changing market (new e-commerce competitors, changing prices and customer taste).

Application (steps)

1. **Set organisational objectives:** Increase sales by 15% and market share from 8% to 10% in 12 months.
2. **Cascade to sales team and individuals:** regional target, each salesperson's target (e.g. Rs. 1.2 crore), together with new customers (20), customer retention (90%), collection of dues within 45 days.
3. **Participative goal setting:** each salesperson sits with the manager and agrees on SMART goals and action plan, as they know their territory best.
4. **Allow flexibility - because the market is rapidly changing:** break goals into quarterly or monthly targets, with a review every month; revise targets if there is a major change (new competitor, price war, supply shortage); use rolling targets.
5. **Monitoring and feedback:** CRM dashboards, weekly sales reviews, coaching and support.
6. **Measuring performance (KPIs):** sales vs. target (%), new customers, repeat business, average deal size, conversion rate of leads, collection efficiency, customer satisfaction score, share of new products in sales.
7. **Appraisal and reward:** annual appraisal against objectives; incentives, promotion and recognition linked to achievement, then set next-period goals.

Benefits and limitations

Benefits: clarity, motivation through participation, better coordination and an objective appraisal. **Limitations:** time consuming; may encourage short-term focus and ignore teamwork or quality; targets can become outdated in a fast-changing market, so goals should be flexible and balanced with qualitative objectives.

Q4) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Analyse the role of diversity and inclusion in organisations. What are the benefits of creating a diverse and inclusive workplace?

Diversity means the presence of differences among employees: gender, age, religion, culture, ethnicity, language, abilities, education and background (also diversity of thought). **Inclusion** means creating an environment in which every person feels respected, valued and able to contribute fully. Diversity is 'being invited to the party', inclusion is 'being asked to dance'.

Role in organisations

- Builds a fair and ethical culture with equal opportunity (e.g. women in leadership, persons with disability, LGBTQ+ inclusion).
- Helps to attract and retain talent from the wider talent pool, and compliance with law (equal opportunity, POSH Act).
- Improves team processes and the brand image / reputation of the employer; mirrors the diverse customer base.

Benefits

- **Better creativity and innovation:** different perspectives produce more ideas.

- **Better decision making and problem solving:** reduces groupthink.
- **Better understanding of diverse markets and customers;** helps global expansion.
- **Higher employee engagement, satisfaction, retention** and lower turnover and absenteeism.
- **Improved employer brand and talent attraction.**
- **Financial performance:** studies (e.g. McKinsey) show diverse companies often outperform others.
- **Reduced discrimination, conflict and legal risks.**

Challenges and measures

Challenges: stereotypes, communication barriers, conflict, tokenism. Measures: unbiased recruitment, diversity training, mentoring, flexible policies, employee resource groups, inclusive leadership, and measuring diversity metrics.

b) Discuss the role of communication in effective management. Provide examples of how effective communication can improve organisational performance.

Communication is the exchange of information, ideas and feelings between people so that there is mutual understanding. Managers spend most of their time in communication; Mintzberg's informational roles show its importance.

Role in effective management

- **Planning:** information from inside and outside is needed, and plans must be communicated.
- **Organising:** clear explanation of authority, responsibility and relationships.
- **Leading/motivating:** instructions, guidance, feedback, appreciation and persuasion.
- **Controlling:** reports and feedback on performance and corrective actions.
- **Decision making and co-ordination:** flow of information among departments; **conflict management** and building relationships with customers, suppliers and the public.

Examples of improved performance

- Daily briefing in a factory about safety and production target reduces accidents and errors.
- Open door policy and two-way feedback at Infosys / Tata improves trust and reduces attrition.
- Clear communication of company vision by a CEO (e.g. Satya Nadella's 'growth mindset') aligns employees and motivates them.
- Regular customer feedback and quick communication of complaints to the production team improves quality.
- In project teams, tools like Slack/Teams and regular meetings reduce delays and misunderstanding.
- During change or crisis (COVID-19), transparent communication reduced panic and kept productivity.

Barriers (and remedies)

Language, noise, filtering, status differences, information overload. Remedy: simple language, feedback, active listening, proper channel selection.

Q5) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Analyse the challenges and benefits of virtual organisations. How can organisations effectively manage virtual teams?

Benefits	Challenges
Low cost: less office, utilities and overhead	Lack of face-to-face contact; communication gaps and misunderstanding
Access to global talent; 24x7 work across time zones	Time-zone and cultural differences
Flexibility and quick response to market change	Trust, loyalty and team spirit are difficult to build
Higher productivity and work-life balance for employees	Difficult supervision and control; performance measurement
Focus on core competence; scalability	Security of data, dependency on technology and internet
Environmentally friendly (less travel)	Isolation, burnout, and unclear work-life boundaries

How to manage virtual teams effectively

1. **Clear goals, roles and expectations;** manage by results (MBO/OKR).
2. **Right technology:** video conferencing, collaboration and project tools (Teams, Zoom, Slack, Trello), cloud storage and cyber security.

3. **Regular and structured communication:** daily stand-ups, weekly review, one-to-one calls; agree on communication norms and time overlap.
4. **Build trust and team spirit:** virtual team-building, recognition, occasional face-to-face meetups.
5. **Choose and train self-motivated people;** train in virtual skills and cross-cultural sensitivity.
6. **Fair performance measurement and rewards;** look after well-being and avoid overwork.
7. **Leadership that is empathetic,** and gives autonomy with support.

b) Small family-owned restaurant facing declining sales due to competition from fast-food chains - develop a comprehensive plan to revitalise the business and increase sales.

Objective (SMART): increase sales by 25% and footfall by 30% in 6 months, and improve customer rating to 4.5 stars.

Step 1 - Situation analysis (SWOT)

Strengths	**Weaknesses**
Authentic home-style food, family ownership, loyal regulars, local knowledge	Small size, limited budget, lack of marketing, old interior, slow service
Opportunities	**Threats**
Demand for healthy and authentic food, online delivery (Zomato / Swiggy), social media, catering	Fast-food chains' low price, brand power and speed; rising rent and food cost

Step 2 - Action plan (4 Ps and operations)

- **Product / menu:** keep a few signature dishes, add healthy, regional and thali items; use fresh and local ingredients, a 'chef's special', and combo meals.
- **Price:** value-for-money lunch combos, student/family offers, loyalty card; not to compete only on price with chains.
- **Place and delivery:** list on Zomato/Swiggy and Google Maps, own WhatsApp ordering, takeaway and tiffin / catering for offices, home delivery; renovate and improve cleanliness and ambience.
- **Promotion:** social media (Instagram reels, customer reviews), local influencers, Google reviews, festival offers, loyalty and referral programmes, tie-ups with nearby offices and colleges.
- **People and process:** train staff in service and hygiene, reduce waiting time, a quick-service lunch counter; get customer feedback and respond quickly.
- **Cost control:** reduce wastage, bulk purchase from local suppliers, menu engineering (promote high-margin items).

Step 3 - Organising, implementation and control

- Assign responsibilities among family members (kitchen, front, marketing, accounts); budget of about 5% of sales for marketing.
- Timeline: month 1 - menu and online listing; month 2 - renovation and promotion; month 3 onwards - review.
- **Controls / KPIs:** daily sales, number of customers, average bill, online ratings, food cost %, customer repeat rate; review monthly and take corrective actions.

Conclusion: By using its strengths (authentic taste and personal service), adopting technology and giving better value, the family restaurant can survive and grow against the fast-food chains.